genuine kind human feelings.

The other physicists were not so easy to approach. There was, for instance, Adolph Paalzow, the physicist of the School of Engineering of Charlottenburg, a gifted experimenter, and a typical Berliner. He would always treat me cordially, yet always make me feel that he had really not much use for me. In those days, I was the only theorist, a physicist *sui generis*, as it were, and this circumstance did not make my *debut* so easy. Also, I had a distinct feeling that the instructors at the Physical Institute were politely but clearly trying to keep me at arm's length. But in the course of time, as we got better acquainted, our relationship assumed a friendlier aspect; one of them, Heinrich Rubens, eventually became my close personal friend, and our friendship was ended only by his death, at an all too early age.

By a sheer whim of fate, no sooner had I reported to my post in Berlin than I was temporarily assigned a task in a field quite remote from my self-chosen special branch of physics. Just at that time, the Institute for Theoretical Physics happened to receive a large harmonium, of pure untempered tuning, a product of the genius of Carl Eitz, a public school teacher in Eisleben, built by the Schiedmayer piano factory of Stuttgart for the Ministry. I was given the task of using this musical instrument for a study of the untempered, "natural" scale. I delved into the problem with keen interest, in particular with regard to the question concerning the part played by the "natural" scale in our modern vocal music without instrumental accompaniment. These studies brought me the discovery, unsuspected to a certain degree, that the tempered scale was positively more pleasing to the human ear, under all circumstances, than the "natural," untempered scale. Even in a harmonic major triad, the natural third sounds feeble and inexpressive in comparison with the tempered third. Indubitably, this fact can be ascribed ultimately to a habituation through years and generations. For before Johann Sebastian Bach, the tempered scale had not been at all universally known.

My removal to Berlin not only enabled me to associate with interesting personages, but also brought about a sizable expansion of my scientific correspondence. First of all, I became interested in the extremely fruitful theory formulated by W. Nernst, of Göttingen. According to this theory, the electric stresses occurring in electrolytic solutions with non-homogenous concentrations arise from the joint effect of the electric force, due to the moving charges and the osmotic pressure. Using this theory as a basis, I succeeded in calculating the potential difference at the point of contact of two electrolytic solutions, and Nernst wrote to me later that my formula had been confirmed by his measurements.

In connection with the problems of the electric dissociation theory, I was soon also engaged in a voluminous correspondence with Wilhelm Ostwald, of Leipzig. Our correspondence led to many a critical debate, yet these were